PRINCIPLES OF DESIGN

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

The elements are the ingredients of an artwork; the principles are how the ingredients are arranged. Part 1: draw a line from each principle to its definition. Part 2: read each description and circle the principle it shows best.

PART 1: MATCH THE PRINCIPLE TO ITS DEFINITION

1. Balance
2. Contrast
3. Emphasis
4. Pattern
5. Rhythm
6. Movement
7. Unity
8. Variety

a. Everything feels as if it belongs.

b. One part catches the eye first.

c. An element repeated in a regular way.

d. Leads the eye along a path.

e. Visual weight is spread out evenly.

f. Repeats with changes, like a beat.

g. Differences that keep it interesting.

h. Big differences placed side by side.

PART 2: WHICH PRINCIPLE?

1. A grey street scene with one person in a bright red coat.
   a) emphasis **b) pattern** **c) unity**
2. A quilt made of the same star block repeated in rows.
   a) movement **b) pattern** **c) contrast**
3. A butterfly: fold it down the middle and both halves match.
   a) variety **b) symmetrical balance** **c) rhythm**
4. Swirling clouds that pull your eye from the corner of the sky down to the village.
   a) movement **b) unity** **c) balance**
5. A still life painted only in shades of blue, so every object seems to belong.
   a) contrast **b) emphasis** **c) unity**
6. Dancers drawn in a row, each in a slightly different pose, like beats in a song.
   a) rhythm **b) balance** **c) emphasis**

For non-commercial, education use only

PRINCIPLES OF DESIGN ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

PART 1: MATCH THE PRINCIPLE TO ITS DEFINITION

Balance = Visual weight is spread out evenly.; Contrast = Big differences placed side by side.; Emphasis = One part catches the eye first.; Pattern = An element repeated in a regular way.; Rhythm = Repeats with changes, like a beat.; Movement = Leads the eye along a path.; Unity = Everything feels as if it belongs.; Variety = Differences that keep it interesting.

PART 2: WHICH PRINCIPLE?

1. a) emphasis 2. b) pattern 3. b) symmetrical balance 4. a) movement 5. c) unity 6. a) rhythm